APPROVED ON NOVEMBER 4, 2026
BY THE BOARD OF COUNTY COMMISSIONERS
AT THE WEEKLY BUSINESS SESSION

Open Session: October 30, 2026
2:30 p.m. - Board of Commissioners Conference Room
Attending: Commissioners Ron A. Smith; Colene M. Martin; Gary L. Richardson; and Nikole Guzman, Recorder
Chair Ron Smith called the meeting to order at 2:30 p.m.

1. **OPEN SESSION**
    a. **To review and evaluate the employment-related performance of the chief executive officer of any public body, a public officer, employee or staff member who requests an open hearing.**

Natalie Eckhardt-Doupe, Interim Human Resources Director, and Ryan Johnson, Facilities Director, joined the Board. Because Mr. Johnson had requested an open hearing, the Board proceeded in Open Session to address the employment-related performance matter.

Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe presented Mr. Johnson with the Performance Improvement Plan and the informal investigation report resulting from the Board's prior review and the October 28, 2026 open meeting. She explained that the Performance Improvement Plan was intended to establish expectations and begin implementation that day, and that an employee signature would acknowledge receipt and discussion of the plan rather than agreement with its contents.

Mr. Johnson read a statement objecting to the process and to the Board's decision to place him on a Performance Improvement Plan. He stated that he had not received the documents before the meeting, disputed the process and several of the performance concerns, requested that the matter be tabled to allow time for review with legal counsel, and requested that the matter be removed from his employment record. Mr. Johnson stated that he was not feeling well and intended to take time away from work, then left the meeting without signing the Performance Improvement Plan.

Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe advised that Mr. Johnson had submitted a formal appeal on October 30. She reviewed the appeal procedure under County personnel policy, including the opportunity to submit supporting materials within 14 days and the ability to appeal an initial determination to the Board of County Commissioners. She further advised that the appeal process was separate from the Performance Improvement Plan and that the plan could take effect that day.

The Board discussed the investigation process and asked questions regarding the informal investigation, the contents of the report, and whether information received from other elected officials had been considered. Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe explained that the matter had proceeded as an informal investigation, that Mr. Johnson had been interviewed by the Board on October 28, and that the resulting Performance Improvement Plan was a non-disciplinary tool intended to identify expectations and areas requiring improvement. She stated that employment counsel had reviewed the plan.

Commissioner Richardson questioned portions of the report in light of information provided by the County Clerk and County Treasurer. Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe explained how those matters had been addressed in the final report and stated that the remaining findings reflected the information considered by the Board during the process. Commissioner Martin asked about Mr. Johnson's statement that he intended to take leave; Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe stated that Human Resources would contact him for clarification.

Chair Smith left the meeting before its conclusion due to a personal emergency. Vice-Chair Martin assumed the chair. Ms. Eckhardt-Doupe clarified that copies of the Performance Improvement Plan had been provided to all Commissioners earlier in the week. The Board discussed the next procedural steps. No formal motion or roll-call vote was taken.

2. **EXECUTIVE SESSION**
    a. **To review and evaluate the employment-related performance of the chief executive officer of any public body, a public officer, employee or staff member who does not request an open hearing - ORS 192.660(2)(i).**

Not convened. Mr. Johnson requested an open hearing, and the Board therefore continued the matter in Open Session.

3. **OPEN SESSION CON'D**
    a. **To review and evaluate the employment-related performance of the chief executive officer of any public body, a public officer, employee or staff member who requests an open hearing.**

The Executive Session was not convened. Because Mr. Johnson requested an open hearing, the Board remained in Open Session throughout the meeting. No formal action was taken.

Vice-Chair Martin adjourned the meeting at 2:47 p.m.